

KeyBank Transactional Disputes: Counterfeit Item Experience

Overview

Customers increasingly purchase products through online marketplaces and third-party sellers. As counterfeit goods became more common, KeyBank's dispute process struggled to help customers determine whether they had a legitimate claim and what evidence was required. The result was confusion, incomplete submissions, avoidable support calls, and higher operational costs. This initiative focused on creating a guided counterfeit dispute experience that helped customers determine eligibility, gather documentation, and submit stronger claims.

My Role

Lead UX Designer responsible for UX strategy, journey mapping, user flows, information architecture, wireframing, prototyping, stakeholder collaboration, and experience validation.

The Problem

Customers frequently confused counterfeit merchandise claims with other dispute types such as defective merchandise, items not received, quality concerns, or seller misrepresentation. Many claims were submitted without the evidence required to support investigations, creating rework for both customers and operations teams.

Business Objectives

- Reduce dispute processing costs by eliminating unnecessary reviews and manual interventions.
- Lower contact-center volume through improved guidance and self-service.
- Improve dispute quality and resolution accuracy.
- Create a consistent customer experience aligned with operational and regulatory requirements.

Research & Discovery

Research revealed that customers often misunderstood counterfeit eligibility requirements, documentation expectations, and dispute outcomes. Internal teams spent significant time requesting additional evidence and educating customers after submission.

UX Strategy

The experience was redesigned around three core questions: Is this a counterfeit claim? Do I have the required evidence? Am I prepared to proceed? Rather than immediately presenting a form, the workflow guided customers through an eligibility assessment before allowing them to submit a dispute.

Experience Design

The solution introduced guided eligibility validation, contextual education, progressive disclosure, and dynamic evidence collection. Customers received information at the moment it was needed, reducing confusion and improving completion quality.

Design Process

Low-fidelity concepts explored decision logic, information architecture, and workflow sequencing. High-fidelity prototypes simulated real-world dispute scenarios and enabled stakeholder review before implementation.

Key Design Decisions

- Stop invalid claims earlier in the process.
- Educate customers before submission.
- Collect stronger evidence upfront.
- Increase confidence through clear expectations and guidance.

Expected Outcomes

Customer benefits included improved understanding, reduced frustration, and increased confidence. Business benefits included lower support volume, reduced operational costs, improved claim quality, and more efficient investigations.

Reflection

This project demonstrated the value of designing around customer decision-making rather than simply digitizing an existing process. By helping customers determine eligibility and gather appropriate evidence before submission, the experience improved outcomes for both customers and operational teams.

Portfolio Summary

Challenge: Customers struggled to determine whether purchases qualified as counterfeit merchandise disputes.

Solution: Designed a guided dispute experience that validated eligibility, educated customers, and dynamically collected supporting evidence.

Impact: Reduced friction, improved dispute quality, lowered operational effort, and created a more consistent dispute experience.